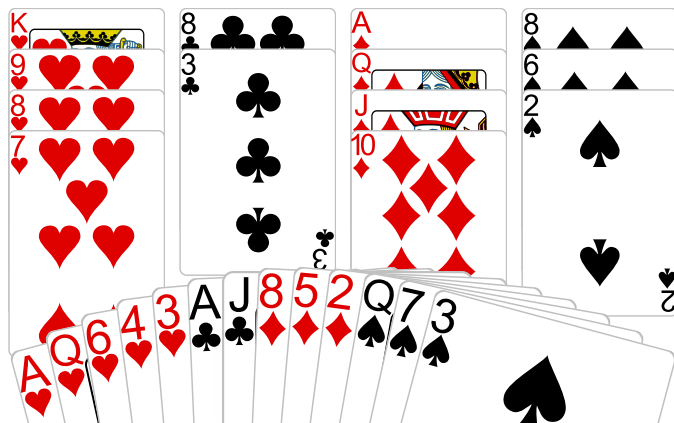
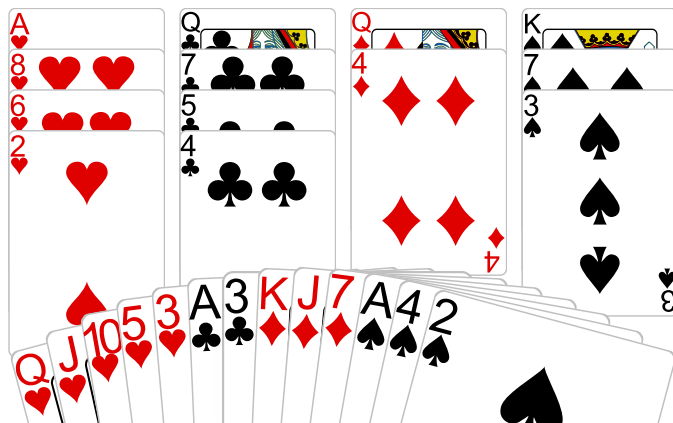


**Deal 1** Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

**Deal 3** Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 5 4  
♥ J 5  
♦ 9 6  
♣ K 9 7 5 2

♠ Q 7 3  
♥ A Q 6 4 3  
♦ 8 5 2  
♣ A J



♠ K J 9  
♥ 10 2  
♦ K 7 4 3  
♣ Q 10 6 4

♠ 8 6 2  
♥ K 9 8 7  
♦ A Q J 10  
♣ 8 3

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♥    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass     | 4♥    |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by North

You are wide open in ♠s, so you have to hope that East holds the ♦K. But that won't be enough by itself, in case he has ♦K x x x you also have to have three entries to your hand. Two of them will be the ♥A and ♥Q and the third entry must be the ♣A.

So you win the first trick with the ♣A and immediately take your first ♦finesse. It wins, so you return to your hand with a ♥ to the ♥Q and take another ♦finesse. Back to your hand with the ♥A (pulling the last trumps) and take a third ♦finesse. Finally on the ♦A you can discard either your ♣ loser or a ♠. You will have to give up three tricks at the end.

This plan would work 50% of the time, whenever East was dealt the ♦K.

Any other plan that was based on East holding the ♦K would work **ALMOST** 50% of the time but would fail when East had three protectors for the ♦K.

You open 1♥, partner responds 3♥.

What is your next bid?

Partner's 3♥ response shows 11-12 points with good trumps.

With your 14 points you decide to bid the game.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♣4, West plays the ♣K.

**North plays 4♥. East leads the ♣4, West plays the ♣K.**

Losers: ♠ 3 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 6

There is no hope of extra winners except the ♦ suit.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 7 3  
♥ A 8 6 2  
♦ Q 4  
♣ Q 7 5 4

♠ 9 6 5

♥ K 7

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ K J 8 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 4 2

♥ Q J 10 5 3

♦ K J 7

♣ A 3

♠ Q J 10 8

♥ 9 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 10 9 6

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

1♥

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by East

you should try to find somewhere to put the ♠ loser.

You have 11 (perhaps 12) points and four trumps.  
Just right for a limit raise.

So you bid 3♥ and partner goes to game.

West would play 4♥.

Click

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠Q.

**East plays 4♥. South leads the ♠Q.**

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You know you can't get rid of the ♦ loser, and it's  
hard to imagine a way that would let you get rid of  
the ♣ loser. The ♥ loser depends on the finesse. So

First you win the ♠A. You know that you will eventually take the ♥ finesse, so should you take it now?  
Visualize the likely defense actions if you do. Say North wins the ♥K. He will surely play another ♠,  
knocking out dummy's ♠K. Whenever you try to set up ♦s the defense will take their ♠ trick and you will  
eventually go down.

What happened is that you gave the defense a tempo and let them control the timing of the play. You should  
not have rushed into the ♥ finesse. Instead suppose that you win the first trick with dummy's ♠K and  
immediately play the ♦Q. The defense can take their ♦A when they want to and push another ♠, but now  
the timing is on your side. You can discard a ♠ from dummy on your good ♦ in time.

Take the ♥ finesse before you set up a ♦ trick and you will be just fine if the finesse wins. But if it loses you  
will lose a tempo and the defense will get to your ♠ loser before you can set up a ♦.

Set up the ♦ winner before you take the ♥ finesse and you will always be able to dump the ♠ loser no  
matter who has the ♥K.